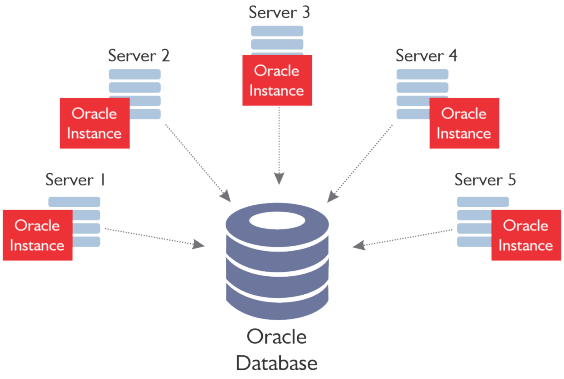
you must specify which to use with the function argument. The option argument is an integer that identifies one of the many options available on the ODBC driver. The parameter argument is the value to use with the option.

8.9 ORACLE

Oracle is one of the most popular relational databases in the world. It is an industrial strength engine preferred by large corporations using databases of exceeding complexity. Oracle database administrators are scarce and command high salaries.



PHP supports two generations of Oracle libraries, Version 7 and Version 8. The functions that use Oracle 7 begin with ora_, such as ora_logon. The functions that work with Oracle 8 begin with oci, such as ocilogon. The Oracle 8 library supports connecting to older Oracle databases. We have included descriptions of the older functions because it's possible you are in the situation of not having access to the newer libraries. Aside from compiling Oracle support into PHP, you may also load an extension using the dl function.

The Oracle 7 functions require two environment variables to be set: ORACLE_HOME and ORACLE_SID. They are most likely not set for your Web server, so you must use the putenv function to set them.

Thies Arntzen, Stig Bakken, Mitch Golden, Andreas Karajannis, and Rasmus Lerdorf contributed to the Oracle 7 extension. Oracle 8 support was added to PHP by Stig Bakken and Thies Arntzen.

Table 9 lists constants created by the Oracle 8 Extension. When Oracle is installed, it creates a test user. The login is scott and the password is tiger.